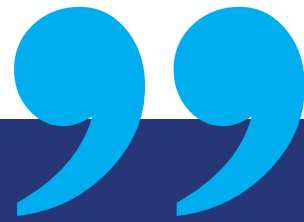




جامعة الإمام البخاري
IMAM BUKHARI UNIVERSITY



Program Description

Department of Hadith and Its Sciences

Deanship of Graduate Studies

College of Islamic Sharia - Imam Bukhary University

Comprehensive Track

Bachelor of Hadith and Its Sciences

College of Sharia - Imam Bukhari University



Details	Statement
Program Name	Master's Degree in Hadith and Its Sciences
Program Code	(0113)
Program Track	Comprehensive Track
Qualification Level	Level Nine
Scientific Department	Hadith and Its Sciences
Faculty	Shariah
Institution	Imam Bukhary University
Program Description	() New (✓) Developed
Date of Last Review	April / 2026



جامعة الإمام البخاري
IMAM BUKHARI UNIVERSITY

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Study Plan for the Master's Degree in Hadith and Its Sciences Comprehensive Track

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Deanship of Graduate Studies - Department of Hadith and Its Sciences:

Vision:

The department aims to be a leading research center and a specialized scientific beacon in postgraduate studies of the Noble Hadith Sciences, enriching the Islamic library with original and peer-reviewed research, and qualifying distinguished researchers capable of actively contributing to the service of the Prophetic Sunnah and the dissemination of its sciences.

The Mission:

Preparing researchers specialized in the sciences of the Noble Hadith, possessing rigorous scientific methodology and high critical acumen, through advanced postgraduate programs focused on original and in-depth scientific research, the authentication of the Prophetic Sunnah, and refutation of the doubts raised about it, in a manner that serves the Islamic Ummah and contributes to the advancement of Sharia knowledge.

Objectives:

The Master's Program in Hadith and its Sciences aims to achieve a comprehensive set of objectives that originate from providing distinguished academic education and rigorous scientific research in the field of the Prophetic Sunnah and its sciences. This contributes to serving the community and enhancing its scientific and civilizational presence. **Among the most prominent of these objectives are:**

1. Establishing a foundational understanding of Hadith knowledge for the student of the Noble Hadith and its sciences, by enabling them to delve deeply into the study of the Prophetic Sunnah and its various sciences according to authentic scientific methodologies. This approach enhances the comprehension of Hadith texts, regulates the methods of Hadith scholars in narration and authentication, distinguishes between authentic and other types of Hadith, and assimilates the efforts of Hadith scholars both past and present.
2. Development of specialized research skills; by equipping students with the ability to prepare rigorous scientific research in Hadith and its sciences, combining methodological foundation with critical and analytical study, employing the methodologies of authentication and judgment of hadiths, studying contemporary hadith-related issues, and linking the Prophetic Sunnah to the realities of life and its changes in intellectual, social, educational, media, and other aspects.
3. Preparing a student who is scientifically and methodologically proficient, capable of contributing to the enrichment of hadith knowledge at local, regional, and international levels, and supporting scientific, advocacy, educational, and research institutions with specialized competencies capable of teaching, scholarly verification, participating in scientific seminars and conferences, and serving and defending the Prophetic Sunnah.

4. Working on employing modern technologies in the service of the Prophetic Sunnah, through the development of hadith databases and the use of digital tools in research and authentication.
5. Enhancing scientific and academic cooperation with universities and specialized institutions in Hadith sciences locally and regionally, through hosting visiting professors, exchanging scientific expertise, and discussing and evaluating Hadith research and studies, thereby contributing to the continuous development of the program and the improvement of the quality of educational and research outcomes.

Program Significance:

The inauguration of the Master's program in Hadith and its Sciences at Imam Bukhary University in the Republic of The Gambia represents a strategic step reflecting the university's pioneering academic vision in developing its academic system, enhancing its presence in the field of specialized Islamic studies, and responding to the demands of higher education and the labor market needs in this vital field. The program is expected to attract significant enrollment from students wishing to specialize in the Prophetic Sunnah and its sciences, and to acquire advanced scientific and methodological skills. This will contribute to elevating the university's academic standing, enhancing its scientific reputation at both regional and international levels, and supporting its institutional sustainability through the scholarly outputs and anticipated revenues generated by the program.

This academic initiative embodies an urgent need in Islamic societies, particularly in West Africa, to prepare specialized scholarly cadres in Hadith and its sciences. These cadres possess the tools of Hadith research, master the methodologies of the Muhaddithun in narration and authentication, and are capable of extracting and critically studying Hadiths in a scholarly manner. They are also equipped to address contemporary intellectual and legal issues related to the Prophetic Sunnah, thereby enhancing the correct understanding of Islam and contributing to the consolidation of the moderate approach while confronting manifestations of extremism and intellectual deviation.

The inauguration of the master's program represents a natural extension of the comprehensive academic pathway provided by Imam Bukhary University. It offers graduates of bachelor's programs in Sharia studies, particularly Hadith and its sciences, the opportunity to pursue their postgraduate studies within the same university. This approach enhances academic stability, elevates the level of scientific qualification, and reflects the university's commitment to delivering qualitative, progressive education that aligns with accredited academic standards and sustainably meets the needs of society.

In addition to the aforementioned, the Master's program in Hadith and its Sciences contributes to meeting the needs of various vital sectors, as the employment opportunities available to its graduates are diverse and extensive. These opportunities include working in educational institutions and universities, research centers and Islamic studies departments, fatwa offices, religious advocacy and media institutions, as well as fields related to imamate, preaching, and guidance. Furthermore, graduates



can participate in projects of civil society organizations concerned with promoting sound religious awareness, enhancing social peace, and combating intellectual extremism. The program also opens prospects for employment in teaching at schools and Islamic institutes, thereby supporting scientific and cultural development in The Gambia and the African region in general.

Employment Sectors Qualified for Graduates of the Master's Program in Hadith and Its Sciences.

Graduates of the Master's Program in Hadith and Its Sciences are qualified to occupy specialized and distinguished positions that require profound scholarly knowledge and advanced research skills, thereby opening wide prospects in academic, research, religious, and consultancy institutions. The following are the primary employment sectors and roles that graduates of the program can undertake:

- 1- Educational and Academic Institutions (Universities and Colleges):** Serving as an Assistant Professor, Academic Researcher, or Specialized Lecturer in the Departments of Hadith and Its Sciences, Islamic Studies, or Sharia, responsible for teaching advanced courses, supervising graduation projects and university research, and contributing to the development of academic curricula.
- 2- Specialized Research Centers and Scientific Publishing Houses:** Working as a specialized researcher in the verification of hadith manuscripts, documentation of texts, study of chains of transmission (isnads) and texts (matns), and participation in major research projects related to the Prophetic Sunnah. Additionally, one may work as a verifier or scientific reviewer for hadith literature.
- 3- Official Religious Institutions (Ministries of Religious Affairs, Fatwa Departments, Councils of Senior Scholars):** Working as a Sharia advisor, fatwa researcher, or expert in matters related to the Prophetic Sunnah. Contributing to the issuance of Sharia fatwas based on evidences from the Sunnah, providing religious consultations to the community, and participating in specialized scientific committees.
- 4- Religious Media Institutions and Knowledge Production:** Working as a producer of specialized religious programs in Hadith and its sciences, or as a Sharia analyst for media content, or as a writer of articles and in-depth studies on issues related to the Prophetic Sunnah. Contributes to spreading correct awareness of the Prophetic Sunnah and its sciences through various media channels.
- 5- Charitable, Relief, and Da'wah Institutions:** Working as a Shariah expert in charitable and relief projects, or as a Da'i and religious guide specializing in issues related to the Prophetic Sunnah. Contributing to the foundation of charitable and relief work from the perspective of the Sunnah, and providing training courses and awareness programs.
- 6- Islamic Banks and Financial Institutions:** Working as a Sharia advisor and participating in issuing jurisprudential rulings related to Islamic financial transactions.

Study Plan for the Master's Degree in Hadith and Its Sciences Comprehensive Track

The curriculum for the Master's program in Hadith and its Sciences, Comprehensive Track, consists of two academic years of coursework.

It is completed by conducting a supplementary research or a scholarly study on a specialized issue in the field of Hadith and its sciences.

The detailed study plan is as follows:

The courses in this curriculum comprise a total of (49) credit hours distributed as follows:

A. Components of the Study Plan:

Components of the Study Plan	Compulsory/ Elective	Number of Courses	Credit Hours	Percentage
Academic Courses	Compulsory	13	40	81.5%
	Elective	2		
Supplementary Research or Case Study	Compulsory	-	9	18.5%
Total		15	49	100%

Study Plan Schedule According to Levels or Semesters:

A- Common Semesters Across All Specializations:

Level	Course Code	Course Title	Compulsory / Elective	Prerequisites	Credit Hours
First	MRMS1111	Research Methodologies	Compulsory		3
	MHTS1112	Hadith Terminology 1	Compulsory		3
	MCTT1113	Criticism of Chains of Transmission and Texts	Compulsory		3
	MSCJ1114	Studies in Jarh and Ta'dil	Compulsory		3
Second	MSDH1125	Studies in the Defects of Hadith	Compulsory		3
	MHTS1122	Hadith Terminology 2	Compulsory	MHTS1112	3
	MSHN1123	Studies in the History of Narrators and Their Classes	Compulsory		3
	MDOH1124	Defense of the Sunnah	Compulsory		3



Third	MHTS1132	Hadith Terminology 3	Compulsory	MHTS1122	3
	MHS1135	Hadith Scholars' Methodologies and Their Conditions 1	Compulsory		3
	MSSS1136	Studies in the Sciences of the Sunnah	Compulsory		3
	MSHR1137	Studies in Hadiths of Legal Rulings	Elective		2
	M AHS1138	Analytical Hadith	Elective		2
Fourth	MHTS1142	Hadith Terminology 4	Compulsory	MHTS1132	3
	MHS1145	Hadith Scholars' Methodologies and Their Conditions 2	Compulsory	MHS1135	3

Important Note: When elective courses are offered at any academic level, the student must choose one of the two courses presented to fulfill the graduation requirements.

C- A supplementary research or case study worth (9) credit hours, with its code to be determined by the Deanship of Graduate Studies, provided that the number of its pages – in this track – ranges between (50) and (75) pages, in accordance with the approved academic regulations and standards.

Learning Outcomes for the Master's Program in Hadith and Its Sciences

A graduate of the Master's program in Hadith and its Sciences at the College of Sharia, Imam Bukhary University, is expected to be capable of achieving the following outcomes:

a. Knowledge and Understanding:

a₁ - In-depth mastery of the concepts of the sciences of Hadith, including Hadith terminology, criticism and accreditation, Hadith defects, and the methodologies of critics.

a₂ - Analysis of the methodologies of early and contemporary hadith scholars in the collection, classification, and criticism of hadith, along with familiarity with the principal hadith sources and their commentaries.

a₃ - Comprehend the development of Hadith studies throughout the ages, the various scientific schools, and contemporary trends in serving the Prophetic Sunnah.

a₄ - Understanding contemporary hadith issues and the intellectual challenges associated with the Prophetic Sunnah, as well as modern critical approaches.

b. Cognitive (Intellectual) Skills:

b₁ - Advanced critical analysis of Prophetic Hadiths, both in terms of chain of transmission (isnad) and text (matn), according to the methodologies of hadith scholars and the principles of hadith criticism.

b₂ - Comparing different narrations and chains of transmission, and preferring among them based on precise scientific principles.

b₃ - Evaluation of classical and contemporary Hadith opinions and studies, and their critique according to an objective scientific methodology.

b₄ - Addressing the doubts raised concerning the Prophetic Sunnah and responding to them through a well-founded scientific approach.

C. Professional and Practical Skills:

C₁ - Preparation of original scientific research in Hadith and its sciences, in accordance with advanced scientific research methodology, achieving scientific contribution.

C₂ - Employing sources of the Prophetic Sunnah (manuscript, printed, and digital) and hadith databases in scientific research and verification.

C₃ - Contributing to university teaching or specialized scientific activities, and delivering reputable lectures and scientific courses.

C₄ - Employing hadith knowledge in addressing contemporary issues and providing scientific solutions based on the Prophetic Sunnah.

d. General Skills (Transferable):

d₁ - Effective scientific communication in writing and presentation, and the preparation of studies and research papers in accordance with academic standards.

d₂ - Working within specialized research teams, and managing scientific projects efficiently and responsibly.

d₃ - Utilizing modern technologies, specialized software, and global databases in hadith research.

d₄ - Commitment to the ethics of scientific research, the values of integrity and academic honesty, and responsibility in serving the Prophetic Sunnah.



Program Learning Outcomes Matrix:

Master's Program Courses in Hadith and Its Sciences	Program Learning Outcomes															
	Knowledge and Understanding				Cognitive (Intellectual) Skills				Professional and Practical Skills				General Skills (Transferable)			
	a ₁	a ₂	a ₃	a ₄	b ₁	b ₂	b ₃	b ₄	C ₁	C ₂	C ₃	C ₄	d ₁	d ₂	d ₃	d ₄
Level One																
Research Methodologies				x			x		x	x	x		x	x	x	x
Hadith Terminology 1	x	x	x	x	x	x			x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x
Criticism of Chains of Transmission and Texts	x	x	x		x	x	x	x		x	x	x	x		x	x
Studies in Jarh and Ta'dil	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x		x	x	x	x	x	x
Level Two																
Studies in the Defects of Hadith	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x
Hadith Terminology 2	x	x	x	x	x	x			x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x
Studies in the History of Narrators and Their Classes	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x
Hadith Scholars' Methodologies and Their Criteria	x	x	x	x	x	x		x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x
Defense of the Sunnah			x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x
Level Three																
Hadith Terminology 3	x	x	x		x	x			x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x
Hadith Scholars' Methodologies and Their Conditions 1	x	x	x	x	x	x		x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x
Studies in the Sciences of the Sunnah	x	x		x	x	x		x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x
Studies in Hadiths of Legal Rulings	x	x	x	x	x	x		x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x
Analytical Hadith	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x		x	x	x	x	x	x
Level Four																
Hadith Terminology 4	x	x	x	x	x	x			x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x

Hadith Scholars' Methodologies and Their Conditions 2	x	x	x	x	x	x		x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x
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The Academic Thesis and Its Requirements

First: Registration of the Thesis:

(1) Registration Conditions and Requirements:

The student is permitted to apply for registration of the thesis topic in the relevant department after fulfilling the following conditions:

- Fulfillment of the admission requirements for the postgraduate program.
- Successful completion of no less than 50% of the academic courses.
- Achieving a cumulative GPA of no less than 70% in the academic courses.
- Submission of a comprehensive research proposal including: the thesis title, its significance, objectives, methodology, and previous studies.
- Approval of the Scientific Department Council, and endorsement of the subject by the competent authorities in accordance with the governing regulations.

(2) Registration Procedures:

- The student submits the thesis registration application to the academic department, accompanied by the research proposal.
- The proposal is presented to the relevant academic committee for review and evaluation.
- After the topic is approved, the thesis is officially registered and endorsed by the College Council and the relevant authorities.

Second: Academic Supervision:

(1) Regulations for Selecting the Academic Supervisor:

- The supervisor is selected from among the faculty members specialized in the field of the thesis.
- It is preferable that the supervisor holds the rank of Professor or Associate Professor; however, an Assistant Professor may be appointed in accordance with the approved regulations.
- It is permissible to appoint one or more co-supervisors when necessary, especially in interdisciplinary topics or specialized fields.

(2) Responsibilities of the Academic Supervisor:

- Providing academic guidance to the student in selecting and formulating the research topic.
- Monitoring the student's progress in the stages of thesis preparation on a regular basis.



- Reviewing academic chapters and providing necessary comments and corrections.
- Ensuring the student's adherence to the methodology and ethics of scientific research.
- Submitting periodic reports on the student's progress level to the relevant department.
- Recommendation for the thesis to be eligible for discussion after fulfilling its scientific requirements.

(3) Supervision and Follow-up Mechanisms:

- Conduct regular periodic meetings between the supervisor and the student to monitor the progress of the research.
- Submitting periodic reports on work progress in accordance with the approved templates.
- Continuous assessment of the student's research performance, with addressing areas of deficiency.
- Adherence to the specified time frame for completing the thesis in accordance with the governing regulations.

Third: Discussion of the Thesis:

(1) Formation of the Discussion Committee:

Based on the Graduate Studies Regulations, the thesis examination committee shall be formed by a decision of the Graduate Studies Deanship Council, upon the recommendation of the relevant Department and Faculty Councils.

(2) Executive Rules for the Formation of the Committee:

- The supervisor's report is presented to the relevant departmental council as a prerequisite for approving the thesis's eligibility for discussion and for proposing the formation of the examination and evaluation committee.
- The Department Council is responsible for nominating the members of the discussion committee, and it may propose a reserve member if necessary.
- The academic supervisor may propose a member of the discussion committee, provided that this is subject to the approval of the department and faculty councils.
- In the event that the Graduate Studies Deanship Council deems it necessary to amend the proposed committee composition, coordination shall be conducted with the concerned faculty to approve the amendment.

(3) Procedures for Submitting the Thesis and Its Evaluation:

- Copies of the thesis shall be sent to the members of the discussion committee through an official letter from the head of the relevant department, within a period not exceeding one week from the date the department is notified of the committee's approval.
- Each member of the discussion committee is obligated to submit a detailed scientific report on the

thesis in accordance with the approved template.

- The maximum duration for thesis examination shall not exceed:
- Two months for master's theses.
- Three months for doctoral dissertations.
- This shall be effective from the date of receipt of the copy.
- In the event that a committee member delays in submitting their report within the specified period, the Department Council – after being notified – may propose an alternative member to complete the evaluation procedures.

(4) Requirements for Progression to the Viva Voce:

- Successful fulfillment of all academic program requirements.
- Obtaining the approval of the academic supervisor regarding the suitability of the thesis for discussion.
- Approval of the Department and Faculty Council for the validity of the thesis.
- Submission of the required copies of the thesis in accordance with the approved regulations.

(5) Procedures for Discussion and Approval of the Thesis

- The discussion session shall be held in the presence of the discussion committee and the supervisor (or their representative if necessary).
- The student presents a summary of their thesis, including the objectives, methodology, and results.
- The committee members provide their academic feedback, which is then discussed with the student in an academic manner.
- At the conclusion of the discussion, the committee issues its decision by selecting one of the following options:

- A. Bachelor's Degree without Modifications
- B. The license with specific amendments applied.
- C. Postponement of the discussion to address substantial comments.
- D. Failure to Pass.

(6) Criteria for Evaluating the Scientific Thesis:

The discussion committee relies on a set of criteria to evaluate the thesis, the most prominent of which are:

- The originality, novelty, and contribution of the topic to the specialization.
- Scientific Methodological Soundness and Accuracy of Documentation.



- Scientific analysis, critique, and the ability to deduce.
- Organization of the thesis and its scientific sequence.
- Language Accuracy and Scientific Style.
- The extent to which the research objectives have been achieved and the scientific contribution realized.

Organizational Note

All procedures for the discussion of scientific theses are subject to the approved regulations and executive rules at Imam Bukhary University.

Academic Staff of the Department of Hadith Sciences:

Academic Rank	General Major	Specialization	Academic Position	Academic and Research Responsibilities (Postgraduate Studies)	Required Number (Male)	Required Number (Female)	Total
Professor	Hadith and Its Sciences	Hadith and Its Sciences	Head of Department / Professor of Graduate Studies	General supervision of the postgraduate programs in the department, teaching advanced methodological courses (Hadith Methodologies, Advanced Jarh and Ta'dil), supervising doctoral and master's theses, chairing examination committees, and directing the department's research trajectory.	1	0	1
Associate Professor	Hadith and Its Sciences	Hadith and Its Sciences	Deputy Head of Department / Professor of Graduate Studies	Academic coordination of postgraduate programs, teaching courses (Hadith Criticism, Authentication of Hadiths and Study of Chains of Transmission), supervision of master's and doctoral theses, and participation in examination committees and scientific seminars.	1	0	1

Professor / Associate Professor	Hadith and Its Sciences	Fiqh of Hadith and Its Various Aspects	Faculty Member (Postgraduate Studies)	Teaching courses (Analytical Hadith Jurisprudence, Defense of the Sunnah, Various Hadith and Its Problems), supervising theses that address the derivation of rulings from the Prophetic Sunnah and the resolution of apparent contradictions, and participating in the peer review of research papers.	1	1	2
Associate Professor / Assistant Professor	Hadith and Its Sciences	Hadith Sciences (Terminology and Biographies)	Faculty Member (Postgraduate Studies)	Teaching courses (Hadith Terminology, Criticism Methodologies among Hadith Scholars, Studies in the History of Narrators), supervising master's theses, and training postgraduate students in advanced Hadith criticism skills.	2	1	3
Associate Professor / Assistant Professor	Hadith and Its Sciences	Hadith Manuscript Verification	Faculty Member (Postgraduate Studies)	Teaching courses (Manuscript Verification Methodologies, Study of Hadith Isnads and Parts), supervising academic theses concerned with the verification of manuscript hadith heritage, and training students in handling manuscripts.	1	1	2

Important Notes for Graduate Programs:

- Teaching and Supervisory Load:** The teaching load for postgraduate faculty members shall be reduced to enable them to dedicate sufficient time to supervising theses (Master's and Doctoral) and conducting research, in accordance with the regulations of the Deanship of Graduate Studies.
- Supervision Requirements:** Supervisors of doctoral dissertations must hold the rank of «Professor»



or «Associate Professor,» whereas an «Assistant Professor» may supervise master's theses or co-supervise doctoral dissertations in accordance with specific regulations.

3. Recruitment: The department focuses on attracting competencies with a substantial scientific output published in peer-reviewed scientific journals or accredited Arabic journals, and who have prior experience in supervision and examination.

Learning Resources for the Master's Program in Hadith Sciences and Its Disciplines

To achieve the utmost educational and research benefits for the students of the Master's program in Hadith and its Sciences, the program at Imam Bukhary University relies on an integrated and diverse system of learning resources. These resources aim to equip students with solid knowledge in Hadith studies and to develop their skills in research, analysis, and critical evaluation within the sciences of the Prophetic Sunnah. These resources are distributed as follows:

1. Printed Books and References:

Available Books in the Central Library of Imam Bukhary University: The collection includes a wide range of seminal books on Hadith, commentaries on the Sunnah, books on Hadith terminology, and the sciences of criticism and authentication, in addition to books on isnad verification and Hadith studies, as well as contemporary references on Sunnah issues and modern research.

Specialized Libraries: Utilizing faculty members' libraries and public libraries specialized in Hadith sciences and Islamic studies.

2. Electronic Resources and Databases:

Electronic resources available in the databases of the digital library at Imam Bukhary University: provide access to thousands of books and peer-reviewed scientific journals in the fields of Hadith and its sciences, through the university's subscriptions to specialized scientific databases.

Peer-Reviewed Scientific Journals: Reviewing the latest research and studies in the sciences of Hadith through specialized Hadith journals and academic databases.

3. Interactive and Educational Resources:

- **Notes and Visual Presentations:** Any notes or visual presentations (PowerPoint Presentations) uploaded by faculty members on the electronic learning system of Imam Bukhary University, which include lecture summaries, mind maps, interactive questions, and enrichment materials.

- **Recorded Lectures:** Video recordings of academic lectures that enable students to review issues of authentication, study chains of transmission, and understand the methodologies of hadith scholars at any time.

- **Discussion Forums:** Interactive platforms for discussing hadith-related issues, analyzing hadiths,

and exchanging scholarly opinions under specialized academic supervision.

4. Specialized Websites:

- **Reliable Scientific Websites:** Websites of scientific institutions, hadith academies, and research centers specializing in the Prophetic Sunnah, providing databases of hadiths along with their explanations and studies.
- **Personal websites of scholars and researchers:** Utilizing the reliable scientific content provided by specialists in Hadith and its sciences through their academic platforms.
- **Academic Research Gateways:** For accessing theses and peer-reviewed research in the field of Hadith and its sciences.

5. Internally Produced Educational Materials:

- **Authored and Translated Course Books:** Books and publications produced by the faculty members of the department, whether original authorship or translations of significant references, which reflect the academic and research expertise of the department and directly meet the scientific needs of the students.
- **Applied Studies and Exercises:** Educational materials aimed at training students in extracting hadiths, studying isnads, evaluating narrations, and analyzing texts according to the methodology of the muhaddithin.

This integrated system of learning resources contributes to establishing a solid scientific foundation for students of Hadith and its sciences, enabling them to acquire skills in authentication, critique, and scientific analysis, thereby qualifying them to engage with the Prophetic Sunnah in study, research, and teaching with competence and proficiency.

Admission and Student Support

The Master's program in Hadith and its Sciences at the Deanship of Graduate Studies places great emphasis on ensuring the recruitment of the best student talents and providing a supportive academic environment that enables them to achieve research and scientific excellence. This is accomplished through clear admission criteria and comprehensive support programs that meet the qualitative needs of graduate students.

1. Admission Requirements for the Program:

Applicants to the Master's program in Hadith and its Sciences must fulfill the general admission requirements for postgraduate studies at Imam Bukhary University, in addition to the following specific conditions:

- **Academic Qualification:** Must hold a Bachelor's degree in Hadith and its Sciences, or in Sharia and



Islamic Studies (General Major), or an equivalent qualification from a recognized university.

- **Cumulative GPA:** The cumulative GPA at the undergraduate level shall not be less than
- A minimum grade of «Good» or its equivalent is required; however, if the grade is «Acceptable,» admission may be considered under exceptional conditions determined by the Deanship of Graduate Studies.
- **Academic Recommendations:** Provide two academic recommendations, especially if the applicant's undergraduate GPA is «Acceptable.» It is preferable that these recommendations come from professors who have previously taught the student during their undergraduate studies, if possible.
- **Admission Tests:** Passing the written and oral admission examination conducted by the department, which aims to assess specialized knowledge in Hadith sciences, research skills, and language proficiency (Arabic and English).
- **Curriculum Vitae:** Submission of a detailed curriculum vitae outlining the student's academic and research experiences.
- **Personal Interview:** Passing the personal interview conducted by the department to assess the student's readiness for postgraduate studies and their enthusiasm for scientific research in Hadith studies.
- **Personal Documents:** Provide two recent passport-sized photographs, and a copy of the birth certificate/passport/national identity card.
- **Written Commitment:** A written pledge to adhere to the standards, rules, and general values promoted by Imam Bukhary University both within and outside the university, especially the ethics of scientific research.
- **Registration Fees:** Payment of the prescribed registration fees at Ecobank, and submission of the payment receipt to Imam Bukhary University for verification.

2. Orientation and Preparation Programs for New Students:

Comprehensive orientation and induction programs are provided for new master's students to ensure their smooth integration into the academic and research environment of the Deanship of Graduate Studies, including:

1. **Reception Ceremony:** Organizing a reception ceremony for new students at the beginning of each academic semester to welcome them and introduce them to Imam Bukhary University and the department.
2. **Introductory Workshops:** Organizing specialized workshops to familiarize students with the regulations and systems of postgraduate studies, the curricula of the master's program, research methodologies, and the proper use of specialized sources and references in Hadith studies.

3. Orientation Tours: Organizing orientation tours of the Central Library, Digital Library, study halls, language laboratories (if available), and the e-learning system.

4. Student Handbook: Providing each student with a comprehensive guide covering academic and administrative activities, regulations, and policies.

3. Guidance Services (Academic, Research, Professional, Psychological, Social):

The program provides specialized advisory services for master's students, with a focus on advanced research and academic aspects.

1. Academic and Research Supervision: An academic supervisor shall be assigned to each master's student from the commencement of the program until graduation, to provide advice and guidance in course selection, determination of the thesis topic, research methodology, and the writing of the scientific thesis.

2. Office Hours: Allocating regular office hours for faculty members to provide consultation and assistance to students regarding their field of specialization, as well as personal and social aspects that may affect their academic progress.

3. Academic Advising Unit: The presence of an academic advising unit within the college and department that guides students and provides

4. Satisfaction Surveys: Distribution and dissemination of periodic questionnaires to measure students' satisfaction with academic and research advisory services, and utilizing the results in developing continuous improvement plans.

5. Career Planning: Providing advice and guidance to students regarding the career opportunities available for holders of a Master's degree in Hadith and its Sciences, and how to prepare for the academic and research job market.

4. Special Support:

The program is keen to provide special support for students with diverse needs to ensure equal opportunities and achieve excellence.

1. Supporting Students Facing Academic and Research Difficulties:

- Identifying students who are struggling in their research or academic track through supervisors' reports and course results.
- Identifying the causes of difficulties (such as challenges in research methodology, scientific writing, or time management) through individual meetings with supervisors and mentors.
- Providing individual or group support programs, such as intensive workshops in scientific research methodology, academic writing, or time management skills.



- Guiding students to participate in specialized training courses to achieve the required levels and skills, such as advanced e-learning courses.

2. Support for Gifted and Outstanding Students:

- Identifying outstanding and gifted students in the field of Hadith and its sciences, and encouraging them to participate in scientific conferences and seminars.
- Providing them with advanced research opportunities and linking them to the research projects of faculty members.
- Honoring them and commending their scientific and research achievements.
- Providing them with opportunities for leadership and pioneering roles in the scientific and cultural activities of the department and Imam Bukhary University.

3. Support for Persons with Disabilities:

- Providing dedicated and appropriate facilities for students with physical disabilities, such as designated parking spaces, equipped restrooms, and easily accessible pathways.
- Allocating appropriate spaces for them in lecture halls and libraries.
- Providing the necessary academic and technical support to ensure they receive a comprehensive educational and research experience.

Quality Assurance of the Master's Program in Hadith and its Sciences

The Master's Program in Hadith and Its Sciences is committed to applying the highest standards of academic and administrative quality to ensure the excellence of its educational and research outcomes at the postgraduate level. This is achieved through an integrated quality assurance system encompassing all aspects of the program, aiming at the continuous improvement of performance, meeting the requirements for academic accreditation of master's programs, and fulfilling the mission and strategic objectives of Imam Bukhary University in serving the Prophetic Sunnah and its sciences.

1. Quality Assurance System in the Program:

The program adopts an internal quality assurance system that aligns with the national and international standards for higher education and postgraduate programs. This system includes clear mechanisms for quality planning, implementation, monitoring, evaluation, and continuous improvement, which are carried out through:

- **Establishing Quality Standards:** Developing clear standards for the quality of advanced teaching, research curricula, scientific research (particularly theses), academic supervision, student services directed towards postgraduate students, and research facilities.
- **Periodic Review:** Conducting periodic reviews of all program components by specialized internal and external committees in Hadith sciences and postgraduate studies.

- **Feedback:** Collecting and analyzing feedback from master's students, supervising faculty members, graduates, external examination committees, and research entities, to be utilized in improvement and development processes.

- **Improvement Plans:** Developing detailed action plans to address identified weaknesses and enhance strengths through evaluation processes, with a focus on the development of research skills and supervision.

2. Quality Control Procedures for Program Courses Taught by Other Academic Departments:

To ensure consistency and quality in the courses taught by other departments (such as Advanced Arabic for Research, Research Methodologies, or certain related Sharia courses), the following procedures are implemented in coordination with the heads of the respective departments:

- **Systematic Coordination:** Conduct periodic meetings with department heads and relevant faculty members to review course descriptions, content, teaching methods, and assessments directed at postgraduate students, ensuring their alignment with the objectives of the Master's program in Hadith and its Sciences.

- **Report Exchange:** Exchange of academic performance reports for master's students in these courses, as well as course evaluation reports by students and faculty members.

- **Joint Review:** Conduct joint reviews of the achieved learning outcomes in these courses and provide recommendations for their improvement when necessary, with an emphasis on supporting the research skills of master's students.

3. Procedures Followed to Ensure Equivalence Between the Program's Main Campus and Other Branches (If Any)

In the event that there are other branches of the program or parallel tracks (such as a track designated for male students and a track designated for female students within a single main campus), the department ensures equivalence in the quality of education and the resources available. Since the current program focuses on a single main campus, this point does not directly apply to the existence of independent branches. However, equivalence between male and female students at the main campus is ensured through:

- **Curriculum Unification:** Implementation of the same study plans and educational curricula for all male and female master's students.

- **Equal Resources:** Providing the same educational materials, research facilities, and advisory services to all students without discrimination.

- **Evaluation Criteria:** Application of unified and fair evaluation standards for all students, including the assessment of academic theses.



4. Program Plan for Measuring Learning Outcomes at the Program Level

The program adopts an approved plan for assessing learning outcomes at the course level and subsequently at the overall program level. This plan aims to ensure that master's students acquire the advanced knowledge, skills, and competencies specified in the program objectives, particularly in the field of scientific research in Hadith and its sciences. Learning outcomes are measured through:

- **Diverse Assessment Tools:** Utilization of various assessment tools such as advanced tests, research projects, seminar presentations, evaluation of thesis proposals, assessment of final theses, and oral interviews.
- **Results Analysis:** The outcomes of learning measurement are analyzed periodically, and the reports are discussed in the Council of the Department of Hadith and its Sciences as well as in the Council of the Deanship of Graduate Studies.
- **Improvement Decisions:** Based on the results of the analysis and discussions, necessary decisions are made to enhance the quality of courses, develop teaching and supervision methods, and optimally utilize the expertise of faculty members to strengthen research outcomes.

5. Program Quality Evaluation:

The quality of the Master's Program in Hadith and its Sciences is evaluated periodically and systematically to ensure continuous improvement, in accordance with the performance indicators outlined in the following table:

Performance Indicators for the Master's Program in Hadith and Its Sciences

M	Code	Performance Indicator	Target Audience	Measurement Methods	Measurement Timing
1	KPI-01	Achievement Rate of the Program's Operational Plan Objectives	75%	Committee Reports	End of the Academic Year
2	KPI-02	Student Satisfaction with the Quality of Hadith and Its Sciences Courses	85%	Questionnaires	End of the semester
3	KPI-03	Student Satisfaction with the Competence of Faculty Members in the Major	85%	Questionnaires	End of the semester
4	KPI-04	Program Learning Outcomes (PLOs) Achievement Rate	75%	Measurement Reports	End of the semester
5	KPI-05	Course Learning Outcomes (CLOs) Achievement Rate	80%	Course Reports	End of the semester

6	KPI-06	Graduation Rate in the Program	60%	Academic Records	End of the Academic Year
7	KPI-07	Graduate Student Retention Rate	90%	Statistics	End of the semester
8	KPI-08	Pass rate in the courses of Hadith and its Sciences	85%	Academic Records	End of the semester
9	KPI-09	Graduate Employment Rate in Their Fields of Specialization	40%	Graduate Surveys	Six months after graduation
10	KPI-10	Graduate Enrollment Rate in Postgraduate Studies ((Doctorate	%20	Graduate Surveys	Six months after graduation
11	KPI-11	Graduate Satisfaction with the Program	80%	Questionnaires	Annually
12	KPI-12	The number of scientific research publications in the field of Hadith annually	Research 3 ≤ Papers	Quality Reports	Annually
13	KPI-13	Average Scientific Production of Faculty Members in the Specialization	Research/ 1 ≤ Member	Research Reports	Annually
14	KPI-14	The Percentage of Utilizing Hadith Databases and Digital Technologies in Research	70%	Course Reports	End of Semester
15	KPI-15	Number of Approved Theses in the Specialization	annually 5 ≤	Postgraduate Records	Annually
16	KPI-16	Number of participations in Hadith scientific conferences	annually 2 ≤	Department Reports	Annually
17	KPI-17	Student Satisfaction Rate with Academic Supervision of Theses	85%	Questionnaires	Annually
18	KPI-18	Number of Workshops and Courses in Hadith Research Skills	annually 3 ≤	Training Reports	Annually



Program Accreditation:

Accreditation Body	Department Council
Session Number	
Session Date	



جامعة الإمام البخاري
IMAM BUKHARI UNIVERSITY

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